

sites such as Yahoo! 360, though, you may need an invite from an existing member.

2.1.2 How Does It Work?

Most such sites work on a simple principle. You can search for people based on common interests, hobbies, location, age, and any other criterion that suits you! One of the greatest things this does is eliminate boundaries of distance. You can also make new pen-pals and keep in touch using the same forum.

Like with everything online, however, there are some pitfalls in the online friendship game. There are a lot of fraudsters out there who may win over your confidence and then try to misuse it.

Once you sign up with a social networking site, you can send invites to non-members to join and keep in touch with them using the Web site. Moreover, you can also find existing members and request them to 'connect' with you and share information and likes and dislikes.

As time passes, your network would grow, and before you know it, you would be part of a community where members share common interests and keep in touch. So not having time outside the office is no longer a reason to not have friends.

In a lot of cases, members often meet outside the online presence if there is a large enough community within a geographical area and get to know each other better.